

The Hague

HUMANITARIAN
DATA FORUM

12-14
June 2024

The United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA) Centre for Humanitarian Data is excited to host our first-ever Humanitarian Data Forum in The Hague from 12-14 June 2024.

This in-person event will mark the ten-year anniversary of the Humanitarian Data Exchange (HDX), an open platform for sharing data across crises and organizations. The forum will convene UN agencies, international and local NGOs, governments and donors, the private sector and academia to shape the future of humanitarian data.

Registration for the forum has now closed. For any queries, please email hdf@un.org.

REGISTRATION: 12:30-13:00

WHEN:
13:00 Wednesday, 12 June to 13:00 Friday, 14 June 2024

WHERE:
Amare, Spuiplein 150, 2511 DG Den Haag, Netherlands

WHO:
130 participants from across the humanitarian data community

The Programme

The programme is shaped around four themes: strengthening our data ecosystem; integrating advanced analysis; advancing the responsible use of data and technology; and building partnerships and capacity. Over the three days, we will be guided by ‘[The Three Horizons’ model](#), a foresight tool for thinking through how systems change. We will start with a focus on the future, then reflect on the present, and finally explore how we transition to the future we want to build. You can download the PDF version of the programme [here](#).

Wednesday – The Future

Thursday – The Present

Friday – The Transition

DAY 1 | WEDNESDAY 12 JUNE

12:30pm – 1:00pm
REGISTRATION

1:00pm – 1:30pm
OPENING REMARKS | Welcome to the Humanitarian Data Forum

Sarah Telford, Lead, Centre for Humanitarian Data, OCHA
Mariëlle Vavier, Deputy Mayor, City of The Hague

1:30pm – 2:00pm
KEYNOTE | An Introduction to Futures Thinking

Dr. Wendy Schultz, Co-Director, Jigsaw Foresight; Senior Fellow, Center for Postnormal Policy and Futures Studies; Fellow, World Futures Studies Federation

2:00pm – 3:00pm
PLENARY | The Future of the Humanitarian System

The current humanitarian system is characterised by complex, frequent and interconnected crises, unprecedented needs, insufficient resources, and a demand for more locally-led responses. Looking forward, what might shape the future of the humanitarian system? What advances are we seeing today that give us confidence that humanitarians can step up to the very real challenges of tomorrow and better meet the growing needs of affected people?

Panellists:

Nathalie Olijslager, Director of Stabilisation and Humanitarian Assistance, Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Netherlands
Gemma Connell, Chief of the Assessment, Planning & Monitoring Branch, OCHA
Minako Manome, Head of Risk Anticipation Hub, UNDP

3:00pm – 3:30pm
COFFEE BREAK

3:30pm – 5:00pm

BREAKOUT SESSION | Drivers of Change in the Humanitarian Data System

Through a collaborative foresight exercise, we will investigate the ‘drivers of change’ that may shape the future of the humanitarian data system. We will undertake a process of collective prioritisation, interrogating which trends, from environmental to political to technical, feel most impactful.

BREAKOUT SESSION | Climate Prediction for a Faster Response

We will hear from climate scientists about the current state and expected advances in climate forecasting. This will be followed by an exploration of the capacities and systems required to fully integrate climate prediction into humanitarian processes to drive anticipatory approaches.

BREAKOUT SESSION | Local Data, Global Systems

The humanitarian community has committed to achieving a more locally-led and contextually-specific response, while seeking to deliver more standardised and interoperable global datasets. This discussion will unpack how we balance these two imperatives, in service to maximising the impact of data for decision-making.

BREAKOUT SESSION | Integrating Novel Data Sources

Novel data sources, such as drone imagery and call detail records, are being used to fill critical information gaps in crisis contexts. How can we integrate these new sources, and the innovative methods that underpin them, into humanitarian analysis and manage the risks and dependencies they might create?

5:00pm – 6:30pm
FIRESIDE CHAT & RECEPTION

We will be joined by Maarten van Aalst, Director General and Chief Science Officer at Royal Netherlands Meteorological Institute, for a wide-ranging conversation on the climate crisis and the consequences for humanitarian action.